

Chord symbols

Chord symbols are used in most genres of popular music.

A chord name and its corresponding symbol indicates the root and type of the chord. If chords include added notes, they can also be indicated by chord symbols.

SEE ALSO

◀ 110–111 Two or more notes together

◀ 124–125 Degrees of the scale

◀ 130–131 Chord types

Blues and jazz

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Basic chord symbols

The five main chord types in popular music are major, minor, augmented, diminished, and half-diminished. The table shows the symbols that are used to indicate these chord types. A minimum of two alternative symbols are possible for each chord type.

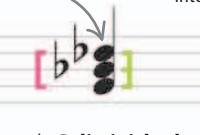
Major chord	Letter name (e.g., C), M, maj, or Δ
Minor chord	m or min
Augmented chord	+ or aug
Diminished chord	° or dim
Half diminished chord	ø or Ø



Δ **G major**
A G major chord is most commonly written as G.



Δ **E minor**
An E minor chord is usually written as Em.



Δ **G diminished**
A G diminished chord is commonly written as G° or Gdim.



Δ **E augmented**
An E augmented chord is usually written as E+ or Eaug.

Seventh chords

A seventh chord is a triad plus an added note that is a seventh above the root of the triad. Chord symbols for seventh chords indicate the type of triadic chord and the quality of the seventh between the root of the triad and the added seventh note, as shown in the table.

Major seventh	Major chord symbol + 7 i.e. M7
Minor seventh	Minor chord symbol + 7 i.e. m7
Dominant seventh	7 (composed of a major 5 th and a minor 7 th)
Diminished seventh	Diminished chord symbol + 7 = °7
Half-diminished seventh	Half-diminished chord symbol + 7 = ø7
Minor major seventh	Minor triad + major seventh = mM7
Augmented major seventh	Augmented triad + major seventh = +M7



Δ **Bbm7**
Since a minor seventh is added to the Bb minor triad, the chord symbol is Bbm7.



Δ **EbmM7**
With a major seventh added to the Eb minor triad, the chord symbol becomes EbmM7.



Δ **C#°7**
The diminished seventh chord, starting on C#, has the chord symbol C#°7.